

RUSHIKESH YASHWANT JADHAV

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

Chicago, IL

Research Methodology and Quantitative Methods, Data Analytics Specialization

Expected Graduation: June 2026

- Pearson Fellow: Awarded fellowship (top 4% of class) for leadership and excellence in global conflict resolution studies
- Coursework: Advanced Statistics, Advanced Program Evaluation, Data Visualization, Behavioral Policy and Program Design: Translating Evidence for Impact, Advanced Decision Models, Environmental Science and Policy

St. Olaf College

Northfield, MN

B.A. in Quantitative Economics, Political Science, International Relations

May 2022

- Davis Scholar: Scholarship awarded by Davis UWC Scholars Program for academic excellence and global engagement

PROFESSIONAL & IMPACT EXPERIENCE

Cook County Assessor's Office (CCAO)

Chicago, IL

Data Analyst (Part-time)

Jan 2026 – Present

- Evaluated Tax Increment Financing (TIF) districts' fiscal impact on municipal revenue by querying property databases using SQLite and processing data in R, producing interactive maps and charts analyzing relationships between annexation patterns, TIF revenue, and local tax levies
- Built data pipelines to extract, clean, and analyze large-scale property tax records from county servers, enabling quantitative assessment of TIF policy effects on city finances

United Nations Development Program (UNDP)

New York, NY (Remote)

Data for Global Development Intern – Data, AI, and Innovation Hub (Part-time)

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

- Designed data-to-policy capacity building programs for 35 government officials across 3 countries, translating technical AI and data science concepts into actionable frameworks for evidence-based policymaking
- Authored data governance report for Uzbekistan's national digital transformation, conducting landscape analysis of technical infrastructure gaps and recommending policy interventions to improve cross-agency data interoperability
- Conducted due diligence and risk assessment for public-private data partnerships with technology firms, evaluating alignment with development objectives and ensuring responsible data sharing practices

Busara Center for Behavioral Economics

Nairobi, Kenya

Research and Advisory Intern

June 2025 – Aug 2025

- Designed and implemented behavioral intervention to reduce child labor across 4 Kenyan states, managing full research lifecycle from survey instrument development through enumerator training and data collection
- Conducted mixed-methods analysis using statistical models to measure treatment effects and NVivo for qualitative evaluation of program impact and iteration strategies

Harris Community Action

Chicago, IL

Data and Technology Fellow for New Community Outreach (NCO), (Part-time)

Nov 2024 – Mar 2025

- Partnered with community-based organization to produce data-driven annual impact report analyzing programmatic outcomes across 200+ participants, synthesizing quantitative and qualitative evidence for stakeholder communications
- Conducted cost-effectiveness analysis of food security interventions serving 200+ community members, identifying optimization strategies projected to increase program reach by 20% within existing budget constraints

Acumen, LLC

Washington, DC

Data and Policy Analyst – Statistical Programmer

Oct 2022 – May 2024

- Analyzed large-scale Medicare datasets (4.4M+ records) to identify \$500M in cost savings opportunities for federal health policy, translating complex statistical findings into actionable recommendations for Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services
- Validated statistical methodologies across 600+ procedure evaluations quarterly, ensuring analytical accuracy and consistency for federal resource allocation decisions and payment policy
- Conducted quality assurance reviews of statistical analyses and cost models, identifying and correcting calculation errors before client delivery to maintain research integrity
- Developed methodological documentation to enhance research transparency, reproducibility, and knowledge transfer
- Facilitated strategic convenings with CMS officials, translating technical analysis into policy-relevant insights and coordinating cross-functional decision-making processes

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data and Coding: Python, R, SQL, SAS, Stata, Ruby, HTML, CSS, Excel, Pandas, ArcGIS Pro, NVivo

Statistical & Analytical Methods: Program Evaluation, Regression Analysis, Time Series, Panel Data, Propensity Score Matching, Instrumental Variables, Econometrics

Research & Strategy Tools: Landscape Analysis, Due Diligence, Literature Reviews, Stakeholder Engagement, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Mixed-Methods Research

Collaboration Platforms: Github Version Control, Jira, Asana, Monday.com, Slack, Git, LaTeX, SharePoint, HubSpot

Languages: English (Fluent), Hindi (Fluent), Marathi (Fluent)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago

Research Assistant – Prof. Mareike Schomerus

Chicago, IL

June 2025 – Mar 2026

- Conduct systematic literature reviews on democratic backsliding globally, applying behavioral economics frameworks to identify institutional drivers and synthesize evidence into actionable policy interventions

Harvard University, ICH Policy Hackathon

Finalist (Top 10 of 401 global entries)

Boston, MA

Jan 2025 – Feb 2025

- Developed stochastic financial model to simulate credit allocation strategies for 1.2M farmers in India, recommending reallocation of 8% of priority sector lending to mitigate agricultural debt-to-asset ratio
- Designed integrated approach combining land digitization and fintech tools to expand rural credit access, presenting policy recommendations to Indian government officials for potential adoption

St. Olaf College, Economics Department

Research Assistant – Prof. Seth Binder

Northfield, MN

June 2021 – Dec 2021

- Developed land cost prediction model using geospatial and economic data to evaluate employment policies, achieving 7x more jobs under \$136M budget than Minnesota's \$546M welfare spend in 2019
- Built propensity score models with U.S. Census and USDA data to estimate 52% program uptake and poverty reduction outcomes
- Contributed to peer-reviewed publication: Gold, M., Binder, S., & Nolte, C. (2023). Expanding the coverage and accuracy of parcel-level land value estimates. PLOS ONE, 18(9), e0291182

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

University of Chicago

Vice President, South Asian Student Policy Association

Chicago, IL

May 2025 – Present

University of Chicago

Writer & Coordinator, Asian Policy Forum

Chicago, IL

Oct 2024 – May 2025

University of Chicago

Orientation Leader

Chicago, IL

Mar 2025 – Present

Acumen, LLC

Writer, DEI Newsletter

Washington, DC

Jan 2023 – May 2024